



Republic of the Philippines
Department of Agriculture
BUREAU OF FISHERIES AND AQUATIC RESOURCES
REGIONAL FISHERIES LABORATORY XII
J. Catolico St., Lagao, General Santos City

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Document Code: SOP 01-10	DETERMINING PERSONNEL COMPETENCY REQUIREMENTS		

Introduction

This procedure describes the competence requirements for personnel which involves assessing the skills, knowledge, and abilities necessary for personnel to perform their job effectively.

1. Responsibilities

- Laboratory Manager
- Quality Assurance Manager

2. Determining Personnel Competency

2.1. Identify Job Roles and Responsibilities

Specific job roles and key responsibilities associated to each role must be identified. Detailed job description can be found in SOP 01-03 to SOP 01-09.

2.2. Conduct a Skills Gap Analysis

Specific **skills, knowledge, and abilities** required for each role to perform the tasks effectively in order must be identified through skills gap analysis.

2.2.1. Current competencies of personnel must be assessed through performance reviews, employer assessment or self-assessment.

2.2.2. Gaps between current capabilities and those required for role-specific requirements must be identified.

2.2.3. Gaps that are due to lack of training, experience, or changes in the role's requirements must be determined.

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2.3. Determine Competency Categories

Key competencies required must be determined. These can be categorized into:

A. Technical competencies

Specific knowledge or skills required to perform job-related tasks (e.g., laboratory analysis, computer skills).

Laboratory Analysis Skills – Skills in analysis conducted in respective laboratory units

Analytical Skills - Ability to analyze samples, interpret results, and apply scientific principles to draw accurate conclusions

Technical Proficiency in Laboratory Equipment - Proficiency in operating and troubleshooting laboratory instruments and equipment

Knowledge of Laboratory Techniques - Expertise in using laboratory techniques and methodologies in accordance with PNS ISO/IEC 17025:2017 standards.

Quality Control - Ensuring the accuracy, consistency, and reliability of laboratory results by adhering to quality control (QC)

Laboratory Safety and Compliance - Knowledge and adherence to safety procedures and regulatory requirements in the laboratory.

Documentation and Reporting - Ability to document results, maintain accurate records, and prepare clear, concise reports.

Computer Skills – Proficiency in using various applications and software used for analysis or daily tasks

B. Behavioral competencies

Soft skills or attributes that influence performance (e.g., communication, teamwork, leadership).

Attention to Detail - Precision and accuracy in performing tests and recording data.

Problem-Solving and Critical Thinking - Ability to identify problems during analysis and apply critical thinking to find solutions.

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Time Management and Organizational Skills - Efficient management of time and laboratory resources to meet deadlines and priorities.

Communication Skills - Ability to communicate technical information clearly and effectively to colleagues, supervisors, and customers.

Teamwork and Collaboration - Ability to work effectively as part of a team in the laboratory setting.

Continuous Learning and Professional Development - Commitment to staying up-to-date with the latest advancements in laboratory techniques, technologies, and regulations.

C. Functional competencies

Skills related to specific tasks, processes, or systems (e.g. quality assurance, customer service).

Quality and Accuracy - Consistently ensuring work meets high standards of quality and precision.

Customer Service - Ability to meet the needs and expectations of customers

D. Organizational competencies

Knowledge related to the organization's structure, culture, values, and goals (e.g., understanding company policies, goals, and strategic initiatives).

The competencies required in each category must be defined for each role. Ensure that the required competencies are in line with the government standards and PNS ISO/IEC 17025:2017 standards.

2.4. Define Competency Levels

Define the levels of proficiency required for each identified competency. These can be structured as follows:

A. Basic Level (1 – 1.99)

The employee has fundamental knowledge and skills but requires supervision or guidance.

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B. Intermediate Level (2 – 2.99)

The employee can perform tasks independently and solve common problems but may need support in complex situations.

C. Advanced Level (3 – 3.99)

The employee has deep knowledge and expertise and can work autonomously in complex situations. They can mentor others.

D. Expert Level (4 – 5.00)

The employee has mastery over the competency and can lead projects, provide expert advice, and guide the organization's strategies.

2.5. Develop a Competency Framework

A competency framework must be developed based on the competencies and competency levels identified which clearly defines the competencies required for each job, the expert proficiency levels, method of assessment to evaluate competency (e.g., tests, performance appraisals, peer reviews) and training and development plans to address any competency gaps.

3. Monitoring, Review and Updating of Competency Requirements

Competency requirements must be regularly reviewed and updated based on changes in work needs (i.e., additional roles and analysis) and regulatory changes.

4. Communicating Competency Requirements

Competency requirements must be communicated clearly to all personnel in order to ensure that personnel understand what is expected of them and provides clarity on performance expectations.

Meetings or training sessions help to explain new competency requirements. The laboratory should provide resources such as guides or training opportunities to personnel to help them achieve their required competencies.

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